★ SPECIAL REPORT ★

THE ACCIDENTAL INTACTIVIST'S INQUIRY

If someone asked you honestly how you felt about your

CIRCUMCISION STATUS

what would you say?

500 PEOPLE ANSWERED ANONYMOUSLY.
HERE'S WHAT THEY CHOSE TO SHARE.

N = 501 RESPONDENTS 4 PATHWAYS SNAPSHOT 2026-04-21

PHASE 1 FINDINGS REPORT · SUPPLEMENTAL PRINT COMPANION TO
FINDINGS.CIRCUMSURVEY.ONLINE

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PRELIMINARY · PHASE 1
AUGUST 2026

ABOUT THIS REPORT SUPPLEMENTAL RESOURCE

The Inquiry's findings live online as two interactive experiences: the **Special Report**, a guided tour of the Phase 1 results, and the **Findings Explorer**, where every question can be examined across every pathway. This document is their fixed companion — the same findings, distilled into a format that can be downloaded, printed, read offline, and cited.

It reports what respondents said. Every number carries its sample size, methods and limitations are stated before any result, and respondents' own words appear throughout. Editorial interpretation is deliberately absent from these pages; the researcher's perspective is published separately and linked in § 12; the report's own conclusions, stated against its pre-registered hypothesis, are in § 11.

THE FOUR PATHWAYS

- **INTACT** n=142 · 28.3%
- **CIRCUMCISED** n=213 · 42.5%
- **RESTORING** n=109 · 21.8%
- **OBSERVER, PARTNER & ALLY** n=37 · 7.4%

Respondents self-sorted into pathways after answering shared baseline questions. Trans and intersex pathways are held visible in the dataset but fall below reporting thresholds here.

READING THE NUMBERS

n = the number of respondents behind each figure. Percentages below n=5 are suppressed; findings under n=20 are flagged as small-sample.

Resentment vs regret. "Resentment" is used for circumcised respondents (the procedure was performed without their agency); "regret" for intact respondents. The distinction was shaped by community feedback.

Infant-circumcised refers to the combined Circumcised + Restoring population.

Percentages may not total 100.0 due to rounding. Comparisons are within-sample only; this survey does not estimate population prevalence.

SUGGESTED CITATION — Pettit, T. (2026). The Accidental Intactivist's Inquiry: Phase 1 Findings Report. CircumSurvey. findings.circumsurvey.online · Data frozen 2026-04-21 (core modules, N=501).

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Eight numbers that summarize Phase 1

Each figure below is developed fully in the section referenced on its card, with its complete response distribution in Appendix A. All are self-reported by respondents to an anonymous instrument; see § 03 for what that does and does not support.

4.47 vs 1.96

PLEASURE FROM MOBILE SKIN, MEAN OF 1-5

INTACT vs CIRCUMCISED · Δ 2.51 · LARGEST GAP MEASURED · § 05

55.5% vs 5.5%

NEVER NEED ADDED LUBRICATION

INTACT vs CIRCUMCISED · A 10× DIFFERENCE · § 05

79.0% vs 38.1%

RESENTMENT VS REGRET, EVER FELT

CIRC. RESENTMENT vs INTACT EVER WISHING CIRCUMCISED · § 06

100%

RESTORING RESPONDENTS REPORTING SOME RESENTMENT

0% ANSWERED “NO, NEVER” · N=103 · § 06

67.8% vs 27.3%

OFTEN WONDER WHAT THE OTHER STATE FEELS LIKE

CURIOSITY ASYMMETRY · § 06

97.3%

CIRCUMCISED WITHOUT A NEUTRAL PROS-AND-CONS DECISION

ONLY 2.7% RECALL A NEUTRAL DISCUSSION · § 07

78.1–98.1%

WOULD KEEP A FUTURE SON INTACT — EVERY PATHWAY

INCLUDING 78.1% OF THE CIRCUMCISED PATHWAY · § 08

81.3–100%

WEIGHT THE CHILD’S RIGHT TO BODILY AUTONOMY FIRST

OVER MEDICAL RECOMMENDATION & PARENTAL DISCRETION · § 08

THREE PATTERNS TO WATCH FOR

The baseline design. Sensation and satisfaction questions were asked *before* respondents identified their status, so the gaps in § 05 emerge from answers given without a pathway frame (§ 03).

Asymmetry. On every mirrored question — resentment, curiosity, satisfaction — the weight falls on one side. Intact respondents rarely wish for the other state; circumcised respondents often do (§ 06).

Convergence despite belief gaps. 60.4% of respondents associate circumcision with hygiene (§ 10), yet every pathway's majority would keep a future son intact and weight bodily autonomy first (§ 08).

Why anyone asked



> *"This inquiry began with a simple observation: as someone who grew up intact in the United States, I realized I had never heard anyone discuss how they actually felt about their circumcision status as adults. So I asked."*
>
> — TONE PETTIT, FROM THE PROJECT'S INTRODUCTION

The survey behind this report is a data instrument, not an advocacy document. Its premise is that respondents should be given a platform to say, anonymously and in their own terms, how they actually feel — and that the answers should be published whichever way they point. The questions were designed to be answerable by anyone: intact, circumcised, restoring, or observing as a partner, parent, or professional.

Phase 1 collected 501 responses across a 355-question master index. This report distills the cross-pathway core of that dataset: who answered (§ 04), how they rated their own experience before any status framing (§ 05), how the two largest pathways answer mirrored questions about each other (§ 06), how their circumcision decisions were actually made (§ 07), what they would choose for a future child (§ 08), how the restoring pathway is physically undoing it (§ 09), what they believe about the two states in the abstract (§ 10), and what those answers, read together, support (§ 11).

Throughout, respondents' open-ended words appear as quoted voice cards. They are individually curated, anonymized, and attributed only by pathway. The report's captions describe; they do not conclude.

How the survey works — and what it can't tell you

INSTRUMENT

An anonymous, self-administered online questionnaire, distributed via open link. A branching "cultural gateway" routes each respondent into one of the survey's pathways — Intact, Circumcised, Restoring, Observer/Partner/Ally, Trans, and Intersex — so that every group answers questions phrased for its own situation, alongside a shared core answered by all.

The baseline-first design. The sexual-experience ratings reported in § 05 (sensation, orgasm quality, lubrication, body image) were asked *before* the instrument asked about circumcision status. Respondents rated their own experience without a comparison being suggested; pathways were attached to those answers only afterward. Gaps between pathways therefore cannot be an artifact of the question framing them as a contest.

REPORTING RULES

Every claim carries its n. No percentage is shown below n=5; findings below n=20 are flagged as small-sample. Numbers are read from the project's frozen aggregate snapshots — nothing in this report is hand-computed from raw responses. Quotes are hand-selected from open-ended fields, reviewed for anonymity, and never machine-generated; all identifying details are removed.

LIMITATIONS

1 · Self-selection. Respondents found the survey through communities where circumcision is discussed — Reddit, Substack, partner organizations. People with strong feelings, in either direction, are more likely to respond than the general population. Pathway shares and satisfaction levels describe *this sample*, not prevalence in any population.

2 · Self-report. All measures are retrospective self-assessments. No clinical verification of status, sensation, or history was performed. Circumcised respondents rate a state they have always known; intact respondents likewise. Cross-pathway comparisons compare self-perceptions, not instrumented measurements.

3 · Sample skew. The sample is predominantly North American, white, and male (§ 04). The Observer pathway is small (n=37); trans and intersex responses fall below reporting thresholds and are held for later phases.

4 · Preliminary. Phase 1 is a milestone snapshot of a live instrument. Module totals differ slightly (core N=501; demographic cross-tabs N=459; beliefs module N=507) because they were frozen on different dates; each figure cites its own n.

What the design *does* support: comparisons between pathways answering the same questions within the same instrument at the same time — especially where a finding is large, consistent across related questions, and echoed in the open-ended responses.

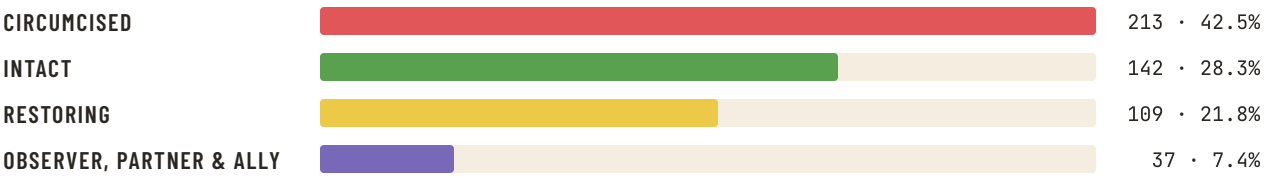
DATA SNAPSHOTS USED IN THIS REPORT SOURCE: PROJECT AGGREGATE FILES

MODULE	FROZEN	N	USED IN
Core cross-pathway aggregates	2026-04-21	501	§ 05–08, Appendix
Demographic cross-tabs (3 primary pathways)	2026-04-18	459	§ 04
Beliefs & perceptions module	rolling	507	§ 09

The five hundred and one

This section describes the sample so that every later finding can be weighed against it. Of the 501 Phase 1 respondents, 322 (64.3%) are infant-circumcised — the Circumcised and Restoring pathways combined — 142 (28.3%) are intact, and 37 (7.4%) answered as observers: partners, parents, and professionals. The demographic cross-tabs below cover the three primary pathways (n=459, frozen 2026-04-18).

FIG. 01 — PATHWAY COMPOSITION N = 501 · SNAPSHOT 2026-04-21



Trans and intersex pathway responses are recorded but fall below the n=20 reporting threshold for this report.

FIG. 02 — CURRENT AGE N = 459

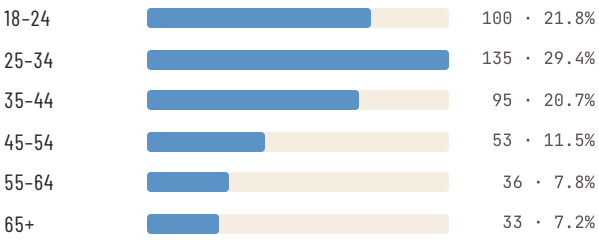


FIG. 03 — GENERATION N = 459

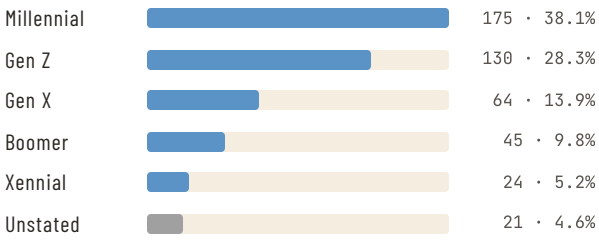


FIG. 04 — COUNTRY OF BIRTH N = 459

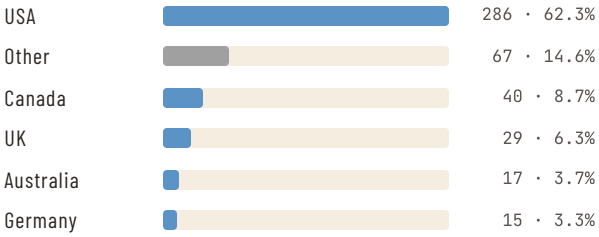


FIG. 05 — FAMILY POLITICAL LEAN (UPBRINGING) N = 459

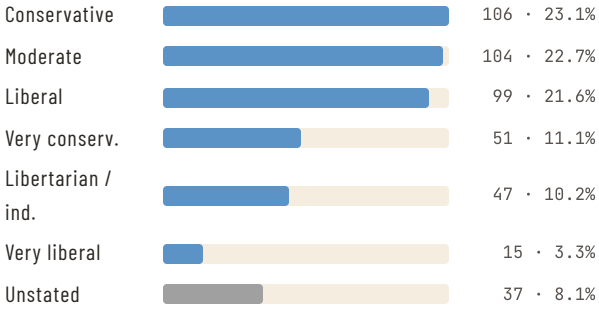
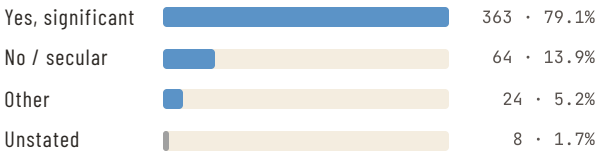
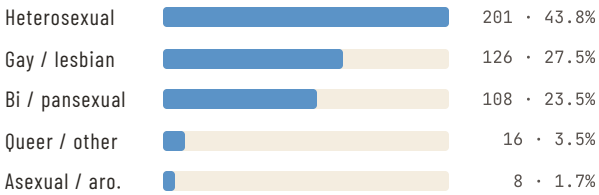


FIG. 06 — RELIGION SIGNIFICANT IN UPBRINGING N = 459



By tradition: 208 Christian (45.3%), 226 none/secular (49.2%), 10 Jewish, 9 Muslim, 6 other — the latter three below the n=20 threshold.

FIG. 07 — SEXUAL ORIENTATION N = 459



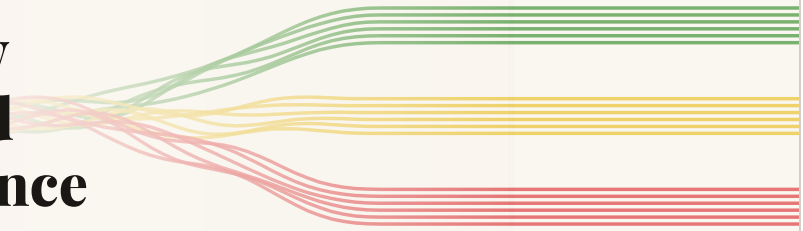
A majority-LGBTQ+-inclusive sample relative to general populations — a recruitment artifact to weigh when generalizing.

FIG. 08 — WHO THE OBSERVERS ARE SMALL SAMPLE · N = 23 SPECIFIED

PARENT / GUARDIAN **7** | PARTNER **5** | MEDICAL PROFESSIONAL **3** | RESEARCHER / STUDENT **0** | OTHER **8**

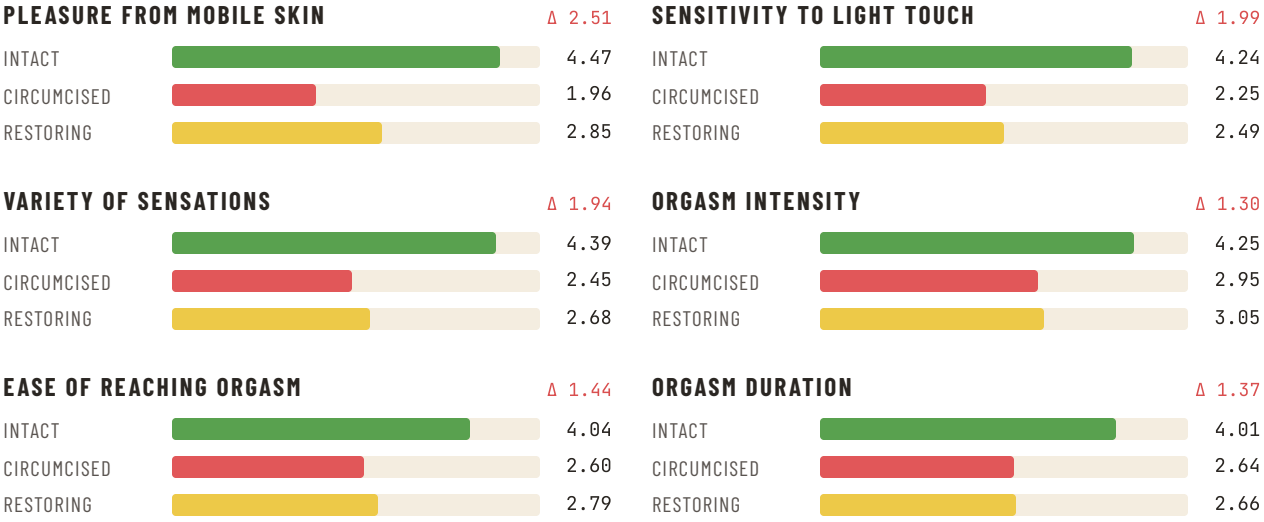
Composition varies across the sample's subgroups — the intact share ranges from 47.5% of Canadian-born respondents to 6.7% of German-born (n=15), and from 39.1% of secular upbringings to 28.9% of religious ones — but every demographic slice contains all three primary pathways. Race/ethnicity: 396 respondents identify as white/European (multi-select; 86.3%), with all other groups below or near the n=32 mark. Full cross-tabs are in the online explorer.

The baseline: how respondents rated their own experience



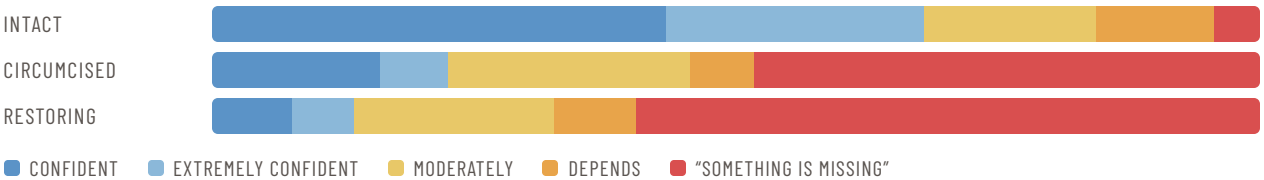
These questions came first in the survey, before any mention of circumcision status. Each respondent rated their own sexual experience on a 1–5 scale (1 = low/poor, 5 = high/excellent), with no comparison implied. The pathway colors below were attached afterward, when respondents identified their status — which is what makes the separation notable.

FIG. 09 — SEXUAL EXPERIENCE GRID · MEANS ON 1–5 N = 142 / 213 / 109



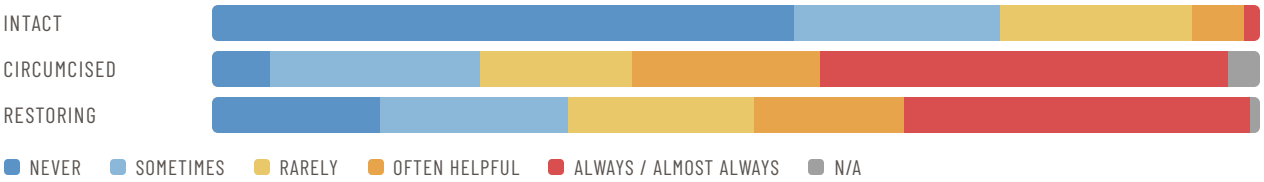
Scale: 1 = low/poor · 5 = high/excellent, self-rated (survey grid Q27). Δ = intact mean − circumcised mean. The mobile-skin gap is the largest single finding in the dataset; the project's documentation notes an effect size of Cohen's d ≈ 1.8. Restoring means sit between the two on every measure.

FIG. 10 — CONFIDENCE THAT ORGASMS ARE AS FULL AS POSSIBLE N = 142 / 213 / 109



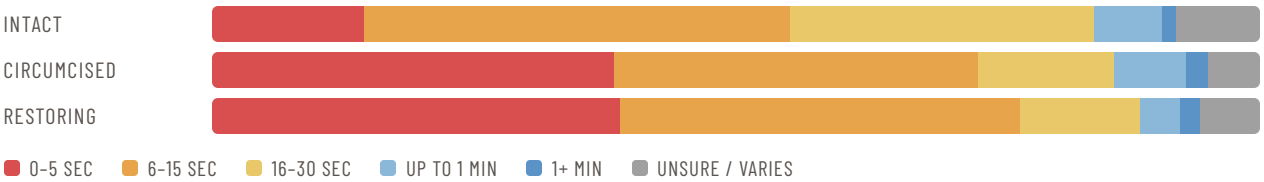
Reading: "something is missing" is chosen by 4.5% of intact respondents, 48.2% of circumcised, and 59.6% of restoring. Full distribution: Table A4.

FIG. 11 — NEED FOR ADDED LUBRICATION N = 142 / 213 / 109



Reading: 55.5% of intact respondents never need added lubrication, against 5.5% of circumcised — a tenfold difference. At the other end, 39.0% of circumcised respondents always or almost always need it (intact: 1.5%). Table A5.

FIG. 12 — DURATION OF PRIMARY ORGASM SENSATIONS N = 142 / 213 / 109



Reading: sensations lasting 5 seconds or less are reported by 14.5% of intact respondents versus 38.3% circumcised and 39.0% restoring; 16 seconds or longer by 36.9% intact versus 21.9% and 17.1%. Table A6.

> *"Negative impact to how I experience pleasure. Not being able to experience the build-up to orgasm from 0–10."*
>
> — THE CIRCUMCISED PATHWAY · ON SENSORY EXPERIENCE

> *"Not as much lubrication [is] needed. He seems to get more pleasure during intimate time."*
>
> — THE OBSERVER PATHWAY · PARTNER OF AN INTACT RESPONDENT

The same question, asked from both sides

Mirror pairs put the two largest pathways in front of equivalent questions about their own state and the other. If feelings about circumcision status were symmetric — each side equally content, equally curious — the mirrored panels would roughly match. They do not.

A NOTE ON WORDING The survey asks circumcised respondents about *resentment* (the procedure was performed without their agency) and intact respondents about *regret* (a state they grew into and could still change). The asymmetric wording is deliberate and was shaped by community feedback; both questions measure unhappiness with one's own status.

FIG. 13 — MIRROR: RESENTMENT vs REGRET N = 213 / 142

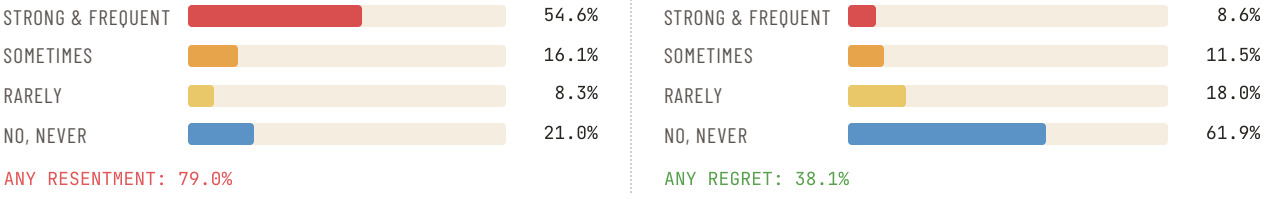
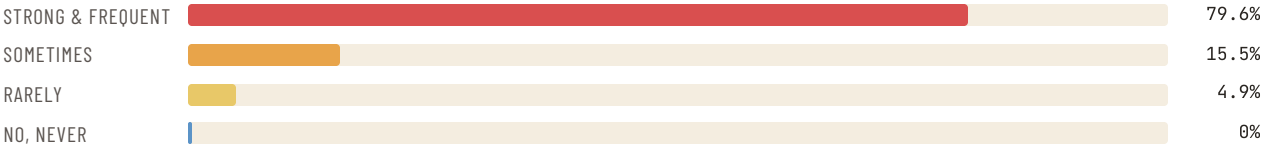


FIG. 14 — THE RESTORATION PATHWAY'S ANSWER TO THE SAME QUESTION N = 103

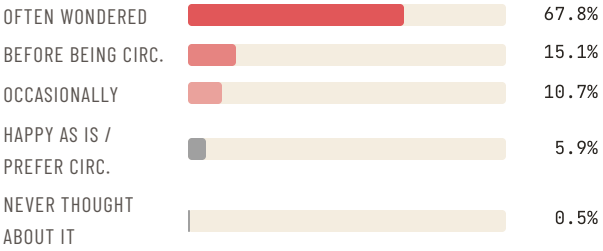


Every restoring respondent reports some resentment — 0% chose "no, never." Restoration is, by definition, the group that acted on the feeling.

FIG. 15 — MIRROR: CURIOSITY ABOUT THE OTHER STATE N = 213 / 142

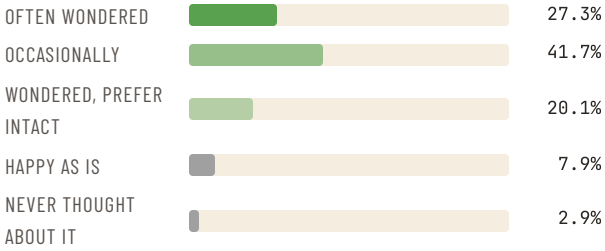
CIRCUMCISED PATHWAY

"Have you wondered what sex would be like with an intact penis?"



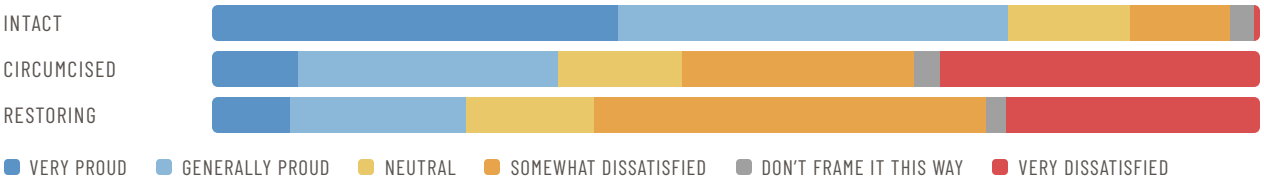
INTACT PATHWAY

"Have you wondered what sex would be like if you were circumcised?"



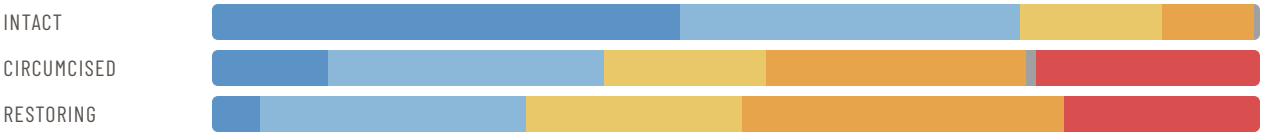
Reading: 67.8% of circumcised respondents often wonder what sex would be like intact; 27.3% of intact respondents often wonder the reverse. Both sides are curious — the intensity differs by 2.5×. Table A8.

FIG. 16 — PRIDE & SATISFACTION WITH ONE'S PENIS N = 142 / 213 / 109



Reading: proud or satisfied (top two options): 75.9% intact · 33.1% circumcised · 24.3% restoring. Dissatisfied (bottom two): 10.2% · 52.9% · 61.7%. Table A2.

FIG. 17 — FEELING ABOUT PHYSICAL APPEARANCE N = 142 / 213 / 109



Same scale as FIG. 16, asked of appearance specifically (positive → negative, grey = "don't think about it"). Positive: 77.0% intact · 37.4% circumcised · 29.9% restoring. Table A1.

> *"Pain. Loss of pleasure. Loss of confidence. Loss of trust. Self hatred. Depression."*
>
> — THE CIRCUMCISED PATHWAY · ON DRAWBACKS

> *"In childhood and through college I was self conscious because all of my friends were cut and I only knew one other kid who was uncut."*
>
> — THE INTACT PATHWAY · ON REGRET TRIGGERS

“I, at 57 years old, have never had a normal intimate relationship… the mutilation is always there.”

— THE CIRCUMCISED PATHWAY · ON LIFELONG IMPACT (RESPONDENT’S OWN WORDING)

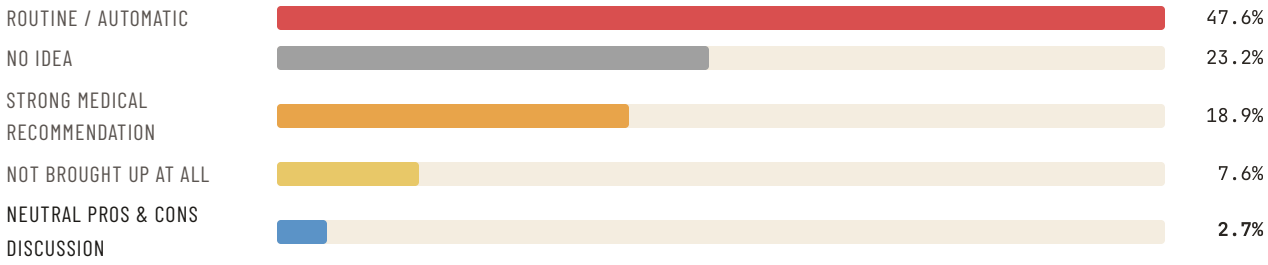
“Only as a teen/young adult due to stigma arising from movies, pop culture, etc.”

— THE INTACT PATHWAY · ON THE SOURCE OF REGRET

The system, not the parents

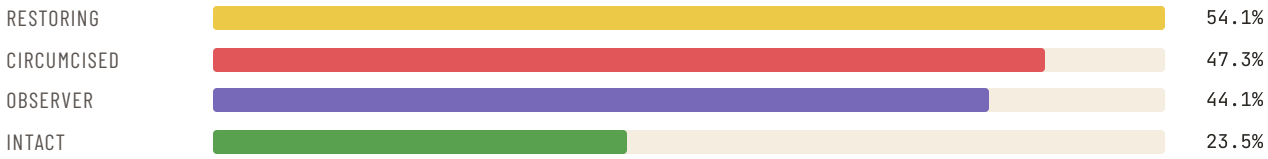
Circumcised respondents were asked how the decision was likely handled around the time of their birth. The pattern that emerges is less about individual choices than about defaults: environments where the procedure was routine, unquestioned, or recommended — and where a neutral weighing of pros and cons was the rare exception.

FIG. 18 — HOW WAS THE DECISION HANDLED AT YOUR BIRTH? CIRCUMCISED PATHWAY · N = 213



Reading: 97.3% of circumcised respondents believe their procedure happened without a neutral weighing of pros and cons. Table A11.

FIG. 19 — "CIRCUMCISION WAS THE UNQUESTIONED NORM WHERE I GREW UP" N = 142 / 213 / 109 / 37



Share choosing "unquestioned norm" as the expectation for newborn boys in their family or community. Intact respondents most often grew up where it was uncommon (33.8%, their top answer). Full distribution: Table A12.

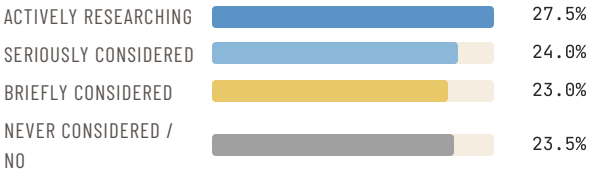
FIG. 20 — FATHER'S STATUS N = 213 / 109

FATHER ALSO CIRCUMCISED



Father intact: 24.2% (circumcised) · 15.6% (restoring); the rest unknown/N/A. A two-generation default: circumcised fathers overwhelmingly preceded circumcised sons. Table A13.

FIG. 21 — INTEREST IN RESTORATION CIRCUMCISED · N = 213



74.5% of circumcised respondents have at least briefly considered or researched foreskin restoration or regeneration. Table A14.

"I wish my parents had given me the choice. I have to live with the physical and emotional consequences."

— THE CIRCUMCISED PATHWAY

"I am so grateful my parents left me whole. I have never had a single issue with cleanliness or function."

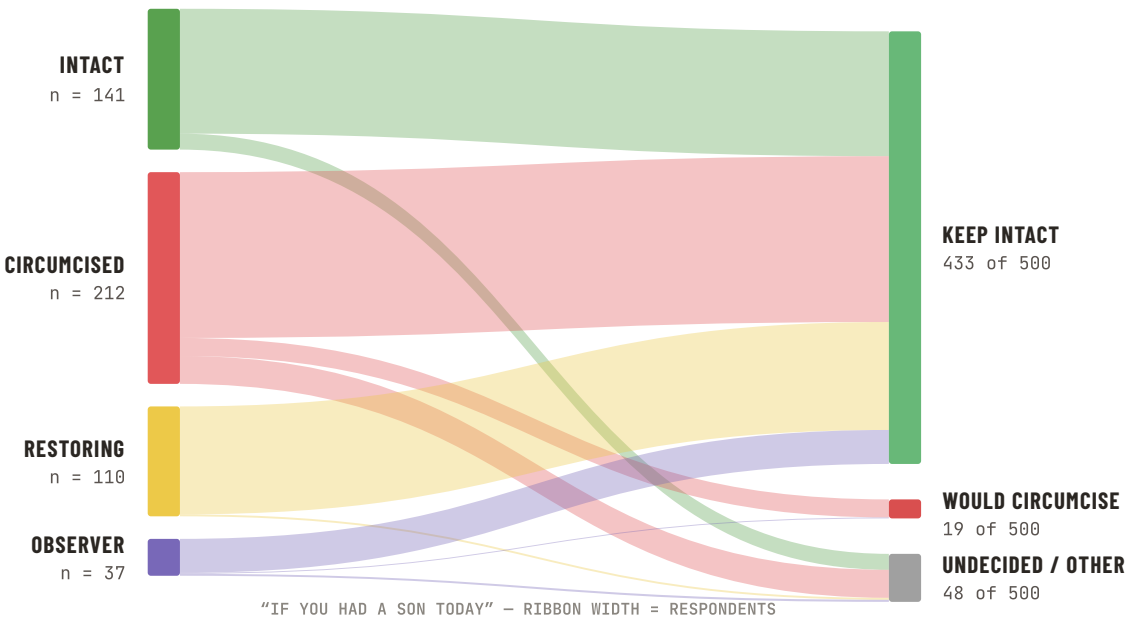
— THE INTACT PATHWAY

Where every pathway converges

Respondents disagree about much — satisfaction, aesthetics, beliefs about health (§ 10). Two questions produce agreement across all four pathways: what they would decide for a child assigned male at birth today, and which principle should govern non-therapeutic, irreversible surgery on a healthy infant.

FIG. 22 — THE CONVERGENCE: DECISION FOR A FUTURE SON

GUIDED-TOUR FREEZE · N = 500



Reading: 433 of 500 respondents (86.6%) — including 166 of 212 circumcised — converge on "keep intact"; 19 would circumcise. Counts are the guided-tour freeze (N=500); per-pathway percentages, including N/A and partner's-choice splits, in Table A9.

FIG. 23 — WHICH PRINCIPLE SHOULD GOVERN NON-THERAPEUTIC INFANT SURGERY? N = 142 / 213 / 109 / 37

SHARE CHOOSING "THE CHILD'S RIGHT TO BODILY AUTONOMY" OVER "MEDICAL AUTHORITIES AND PARENTAL DISCRETION"



The question named the alternative explicitly; respondents chose between two stated principles. Table A10.

> *"Making a decision about changing somebody else's body in a non-medically necessary way is wrong."*
>
> — THE INTACT PATHWAY

> *"His body his choice. Circumcision is a permanent lifetime decision."*
>
> — THE CIRCUMCISED PATHWAY

> *"It's frustrating that I have to spend years of my adult life undoing a 5-minute cosmetic procedure I didn't ask for."*
>
> — THE RESTORATION PATHWAY

> *"In my practice, I now actively counsel parents against the procedure unless there is a strict medical necessity."*
>
> — THE OBSERVER PATHWAY · MEDICAL PROFESSIONAL

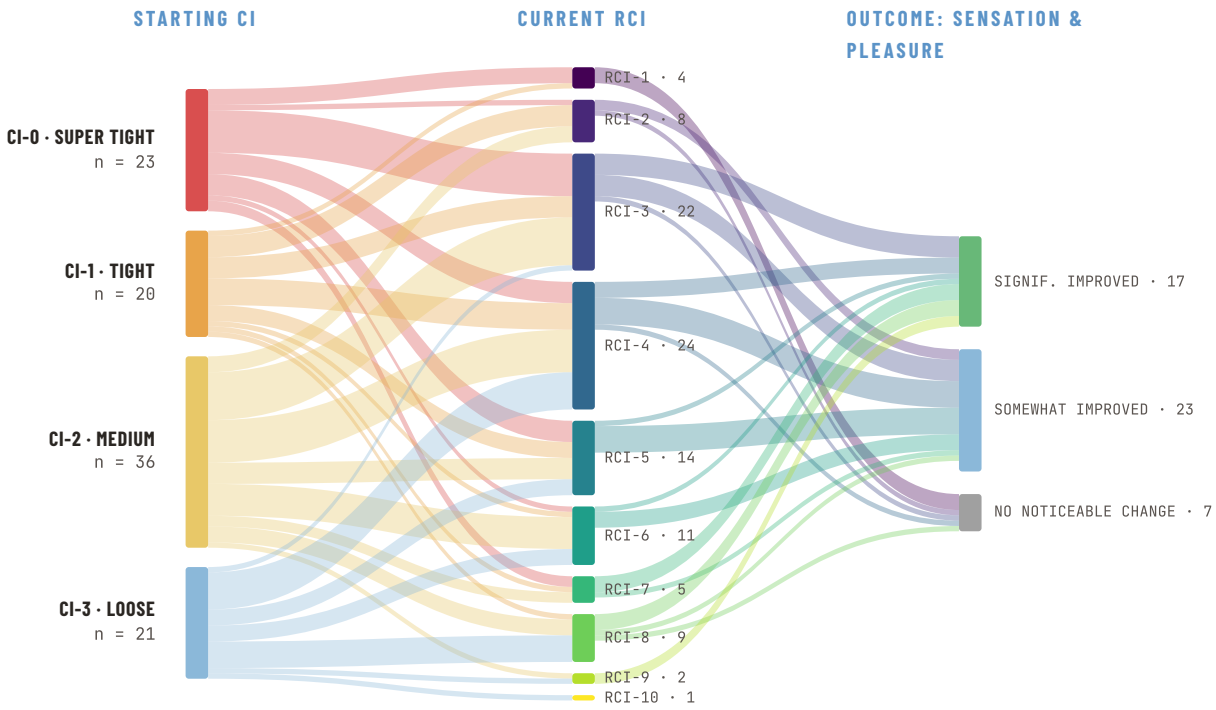
Undoing it by hand

One pathway answers the resentment data with action. 109 respondents — 21.8% of the sample, a third of its infant-circumcised population — are actively restoring: regrowing foreskin coverage through gradual, non-surgical tissue expansion, a process measured in months and years. § 07 showed the demand side (74.5% of circumcised respondents have at least considered it, FIG 21); this section follows the people who went ahead.

Restorers track progress on the **Real Coverage Index (RCI)**, the community's 0–10 scale: RCI-0 is a "super tight" cut with no slack when soft; RCI-4 is the first intermittent rollover — "The Hump," where regrown skin first stays over the glans; RCI-6 is full flaccid coverage; RCI-10, full erect coverage with overhang. The survey asked each restorer for a starting score and a current one; a later grid asked what the journey has done for sensation and pleasure. Read left to right, the three stages are the journey:

FIG. 24 — THE RESTORATION PATHWAY: STARTING CI → CURRENT RCI → OUTCOME

RAW-RESPONSE CROSS-TABS · STAGE N = 100 / 45



RIBBON WIDTH = RESPONDENTS · STAGE Ns VARY WITH RESPONSE COMPLETENESS

Reading, left to right: every journey begins in the cut band (CI 0–3, by definition), and 66 of 100 have climbed past RCI-3 — 24 at the Hump, 30 in flaccid coverage, 12 at erect coverage. Of the 45 who rated the outcome, 38 report improved sensation & pleasure (17 significantly). Stage pairs cross-tabbed independently from raw responses for this report; RCI-unfamiliar and "not a primary goal" answers excluded. Wording: Appendix B.

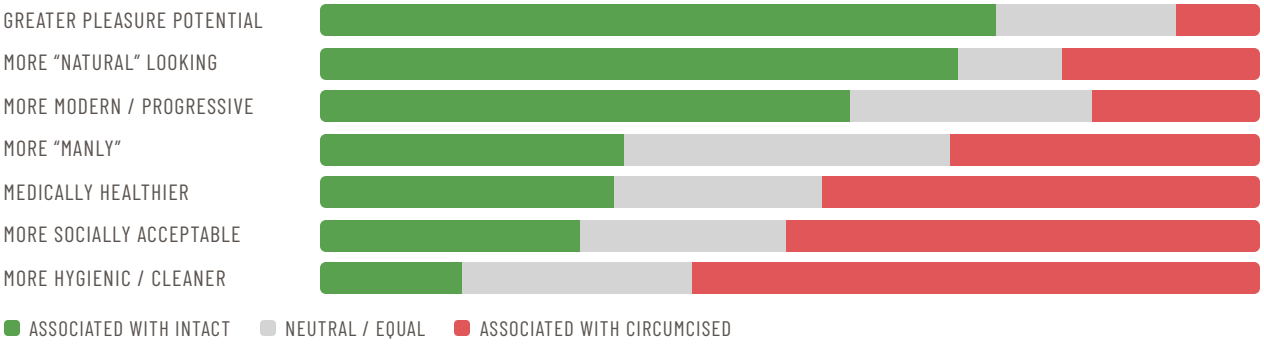
What restoration buys shows up in the baseline data: restoring respondents sit above non-restoring circumcised respondents on every § 05 sensation measure — mobile-skin pleasure 2.85 versus 1.96, light touch 2.49 versus 2.25, variety 2.68 versus 2.45 — while remaining well below intact means (FIG 09). The regain is partial by their own account, and it is slow: what was removed in minutes is rebuilt over years. Their forward-looking answers are the strongest of any pathway — 98.1% would keep a future son intact (FIG 22); 100% weight bodily autonomy first (FIG 23).

> *"Restoring has given me back some sensitivity, but I can never get back the specialized nerve endings that were taken."*
>
> — THE RESTORATION PATHWAY

What respondents believe about the two states

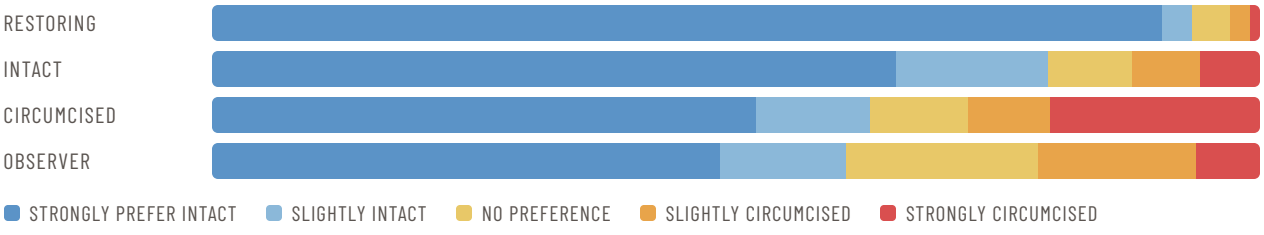
Separately from their own experience, respondents were asked which state they *believe* is more likely to carry each of seven attributes. The answers pull in different directions — circumcision is widely associated with hygiene and social acceptability, intactness with sensation and naturalness — which makes the behavioral convergence of § 08 the more notable.

FIG. 25 — WHICH STATE DO YOU ASSOCIATE WITH… ALL PATHWAYS · N = 474–478 PER ROW



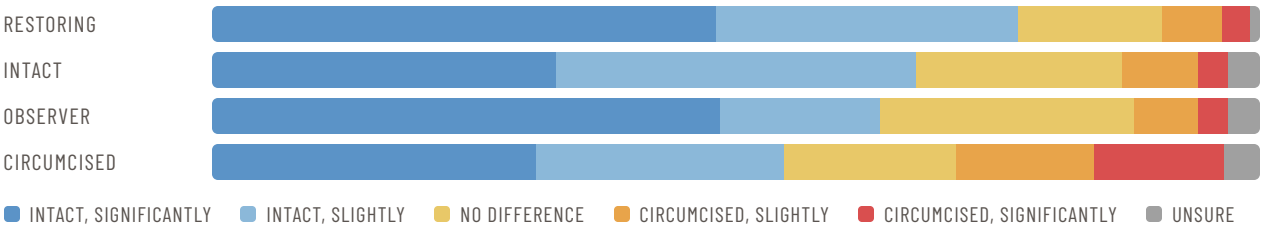
All pathways combined, beliefs module (rolling snapshot, N=507 total; per-row n shown above). Percentages computed from published response counts. Table A16.

FIG. 26 — PERSONAL AESTHETIC PREFERENCE N = 142 / 213 / 109 / 37



Reading: every pathway's majority prefers the intact appearance — including 62.8% of circumcised respondents (20.1% strongly prefer circumcised). Table A15.

FIG. 27 — INTELLECTUAL BELIEF: WHICH STATE IS MEDICALLY HEALTHIER? N = 142 / 213 / 109 / 37



Asked as a belief question ("putting aside your personal satisfaction…"). Net "intact healthier": 67.1% intact · 54.6% circumcised · 76.8% restoring · 63.7% observer — a different picture than the all-pathway hygiene association in FIG. 25. Table A17.

> *"A natural penis is just as healthy and clean as a circumcised one."*
>
> — THE INTACT PATHWAY

> *"The foreskin is not a birth defect. It serves a very specific and highly sensitive function."*
>
> — THE CIRCUMCISED PATHWAY

What Phase 1 supports

The inquiry stated its working hypothesis before the first response arrived:

> *"The routine practice of infant circumcision, perpetuated by cultural inertia and systemic failures in informed consent, results in a statistically significant and widespread negative impact on the lifelong physical, sexual, and psychological well-being of the individuals subjected to it."*
>
> — THE PROJECT'S CENTRAL HYPOTHESIS, STATED AT LAUNCH

Within the limits set out in § 03 — a self-selected, self-reported, preliminary sample — the Phase 1 data is consistent with that hypothesis on each of its clauses:

1. **Cultural inertia, observed.** 47.6% of circumcised respondents' procedures were routine or automatic and 97.3% involved no neutral weighing of pros and cons (FIG 18); the strongest signals in the decision data are environmental — the unquestioned norm (FIG 19) and the father's own status (FIG 20).
2. **Negative impact, self-reported.** Infant-circumcised respondents score lower on all six baseline sensation measures, rated before status was asked (Δ up to 2.51 of 5, FIG 09); need added lubrication at ten times the intact rate (FIG 11); report resentment at twice the rate intact respondents report regret (79.0% vs 38.1%, FIG 13); and half say "something is missing" (FIG 10).
3. **The lived response.** 74.5% of circumcised respondents have considered restoration (FIG 21) and 109 are doing it, by hand, over years (FIG 24). Given the same decision for a son, every pathway's majority — 78.1% to 98.1% — would not repeat it (FIG 22), and 81.3–100% put the child's bodily autonomy first (FIG 23).

What the data does not support: prevalence claims for any wider population, or clinical causation — § 03's limitations are not fine print. And the dataset holds real, countable satisfaction with circumcision: 21.0% report no resentment ever, 8.5% would circumcise a son,

20.1% strongly prefer the circumcised appearance. Those answers appear in every figure and table beside the majorities.

Read together, the answers describe a practice sustained less by the preferences of the people living with its results than by defaults nobody was asked to examine. Whether that should continue is not a question this report can settle — it is the question the data hands to you, and the next page holds the doors.

Now you know. Three doors from here.

DOOR 01

Explore the full dataset

Every question, every pathway, live — the Master Index of 355 questions, all 14 exhibits, and the Docent research assistant.

findings.circumsurvey.online

DOOR 02

Add your response

The survey is live and anonymous. Phase 2 grows from every new respondent — intact, circumcised, restoring, or observing.

circumsurvey.online

DOOR 03

The researcher's perspective

Interpretation and commentary live off these pages, clearly labeled as such, on the Accidental Intactivist Substack.

theaccidentalintactivist.substack.com

STRATEGIC PARTNERS

This inquiry began independently; its commitment to data-driven research has earned active collaboration with key organizations in genital autonomy, legal advocacy, and men's health.

GALDEF

GENITAL AUTONOMY LEGAL DEFENSE & EDUCATION FUND (GALDEF)

Headed by human rights activist Tim Hammond (NOHARMM), GALDEF educates and supports attorneys in impact litigation to expand the US legal landscape protecting all children from forced genital cutting. Its strategic advice has opened paths toward potential academic review of this inquiry.

galdef.org

WiBM

WASHINGTON INITIATIVE FOR BOYS AND MEN (WIBM)

The leading political advocacy group for men's and boys' issues in Washington State, putting this survey's Washington-specific data to work.

wibm.us

INTACT GLOBAL

Strategic partner working to secure for boys the same legal right to bodily integrity already afforded to girls in Washington State, alongside global legal challenges to forced genital cutting.

intactglobal.org

DOCTORS OPPOSING CIRCUMCISION (DOC)

A foundational, Seattle-based international organization of physicians and health professionals advocating for genital autonomy since 1995, challenging the practice on medical and ethical grounds — in direct collaboration with this inquiry.

doctorsopposingcircumcision.org

ACKNOWLEDGMENT

To the five hundred and one people who answered a question almost nobody asks: this document exists because you did.

Questions, corrections, media:
tone@circumsurvey.online

ANONYMOUS QUOTES SELECTED FROM OPEN-ENDED RESPONSES. ALL IDENTIFYING DETAILS REMOVED.

APPENDIX A — RESPONSE TABLES

TABLES A1–A17

Complete distributions for every question cited in the body, verbatim from the frozen aggregate snapshots. Percentages are of each pathway's respondents to that question and may not total 100.0 due to rounding.

TABLE A1 — FEELING ABOUT PHYSICAL APPEARANCE

N = 142 / 213 / 109

`exp_appearance_feeling`

"Thinking about your penis today, how do you generally FEEL about its physical appearance?"

RESPONSE	INTACT %	CIRCUMCISED %	RESTORING %
Very positive	44.6	11.2	4.7
Positive	32.4	26.2	25.2
Neutral	13.7	15.5	20.6
Negative	8.6	24.8	30.8
Don't think about it much	0.7	1.0	0
Very negative	0	21.4	18.7

TABLE A2 — PRIDE & SATISFACTION

N = 142 / 213 / 109

`exp_pride_satisfaction_rating`

"Overall, how PROUD or satisfied are you with your penis, considering all aspects (appearance, how it functions, and the pleasure it provides)?"

RESPONSE	INTACT %	CIRCUMCISED %	RESTORING %
Very proud and satisfied	38.7	8.3	7.5
Generally proud and satisfied	37.2	24.8	16.8
Neutral or ambivalent	11.7	11.7	12.1
Somewhat dissatisfied	9.5	22.3	37.4
Don't frame it in these terms	2.2	2.4	1.9
Very dissatisfied	0.7	30.6	24.3

TABLE A3 — SEXUAL EXPERIENCE GRID — MEANS ON 1-5

N = 142 / 213 / 109

exp_sex_rating_orgasm_intensity · _orgasm_duration · _ease_of_orgasm · _sensitivity_light_touch · _pleasure_mobile_skin · _variety_of_sensation

"Please rate the following aspects of your sexual experience (1 = Low/Poor, 5 = High/Excellent): the INTENSITY of your orgasms · the DURATION of your orgasms · your OVERALL EASE of reaching orgasm · your SENSITIVITY to light touch · your PLEASURE from mobile skin · the VARIETY of pleasurable sensations you experience."

MEASURE	INTACT	CIRCUMCISED	RESTORING	Δ I–C
Pleasure from mobile skin	4.47	1.96	2.85	2.51
Sensitivity to light touch	4.24	2.25	2.49	1.99
Variety of sensations	4.39	2.45	2.68	1.94
Orgasm intensity	4.25	2.95	3.05	1.30
Ease of reaching orgasm	4.04	2.60	2.79	1.44
Orgasm duration (rated)	4.01	2.64	2.66	1.37

Scale: 1 = low/poor, 5 = high/excellent. Asked before status identification.

TABLE A4 — CONFIDENCE ORGASMS ARE AS FULL AS POSSIBLE

N = 142 / 213 / 109

exp_orgasm_confidence_rating

"And, if you're comfortable sharing, how would you rate your general confidence that your orgasms are as intense or fulfilling as possible?"

RESPONSE	INTACT %	CIRCUMCISED %	RESTORING %
Confident	43.3	16.1	7.7
Extremely confident	24.6	6.5	5.8
Moderately confident	16.4	23.1	19.2
Depends	11.2	6.0	7.7
"Something is missing"	4.5	48.2	59.6

TABLE A5 — NEED FOR ADDED LUBRICATION

N = 142 / 213 / 109

exp_lubrication_need

"Do you generally need to use artificial LUBRICATION during sexual activity?"

RESPONSE	INTACT %	CIRCUMCISED %	RESTORING %
Never	55.5	5.5	16.0
Sometimes	19.7	20.0	17.9
Rarely	18.2	14.5	17.9
Often helpful	5.1	18.0	14.2
Always / almost always	1.5	39.0	33.0
N/A	0	3.0	0.9

TABLE A6 — DURATION OF PRIMARY ORGASM SENSATIONS

N = 142 / 213 / 109

exp_orgasm_duration_desc

"DURATION: How long do the primary pleasurable sensations of your typical orgasm last?"

RESPONSE	INTACT %	CIRCUMCISED %	RESTORING %
0–5 sec	14.5	38.3	39.0
6–15 sec	40.6	34.8	38.1
16–30 sec	29.0	12.9	11.4
Up to 1 min	6.5	7.0	3.8
1+ min	1.4	2.0	1.9
Unsure	5.1	1.5	2.9
Varies	2.9	3.5	2.9

TABLE A7 — RESENTMENT (CIRCUMCISED, RESTORING) / REGRET (INTACT)

N = 213 / 103 / 142

circ_regret_feeling · intact_regret_feeling

"Circumcised & Restoring: "Have you experienced resentment, loss, anger, or grief about your circumcision?" — Intact: "Have you ever wished you were circumcised, or felt regret about being intact?""

RESPONSE	CIRCUMCISED %	RESTORING %	INTACT %
Strong & frequent	54.6	79.6	8.6
Sometimes	16.1	15.5	11.5
Rarely	8.3	4.9	18.0
No, never	21.0	0	61.9

Intact respondents were asked the regret variant ("ever wished you were circumcised"). See the wording note in § 06.

TABLE A8 — CURIOSITY ABOUT THE OTHER STATE

N = 213 / 142

`circ_curiosity_about_intact · intact_curiosity_about_circ`

"Have you ever wondered what it would be like to experience sex or masturbation with an intact penis (i.e., with a complete foreskin)? / … with a CIRCUMCISED penis?"

RESPONSE	CIRCUMCISED %	INTACT %
Often wondered	67.8	27.3
Occasionally	10.7	41.7
Wondered before being circumcised	15.1	—
Wondered; prefer own state	—	20.1
Happy as is	3.9	7.9
Other state seems preferable	2.0	—
Never thought about it	0.5	2.9

Option sets differ slightly between the mirrored questions; — = not offered.

TABLE A9 — DECISION FOR A FUTURE SON

N = 142 / 213 / 109 / 37

`final_child_decision_reason`

"Based on everything you know and have experienced, if you were to have a child assigned male at birth today, what would your decision regarding circumcision be, and what is the single most important reason for that choice?"

RESPONSE	INTACT %	CIRC. %	REST. %	OBS. %
Keep intact	88.8	78.1	98.1	90.9
N/A	7.5	6.0	1.9	3.0
Undecided	2.2	4.0	0	0
Partner's choice	1.5	3.5	0	3.0
Circumcise	0	8.5	0	3.0

TABLE A10 — GOVERNING PRINCIPLE FOR NON-THERAPEUTIC INFANT SURGERY

N = 142 / 213 / 109 / 37

`final_core_principle_choice`

"When considering a NON-THERAPEUTIC, irreversible surgical procedure on a healthy infant, which principle do you believe should be given more weight?"

RESPONSE	INTACT %	CIRC. %	REST. %	OBS. %
Child's right to bodily autonomy	96.4	81.3	100.0	97.0
Medical authorities & parental discretion	3.6	18.7	0	3.0

TABLE A11 — HOW WAS THE DECISION HANDLED AT YOUR BIRTH?

CIRCUMCISED · N = 213

cf. intact_parents_handling_of_topic (circumcised-pathway variant)

"Based on what you know, how was the topic of circumcision likely handled around the time of your birth?"

RESPONSE	%
Routine / automatic	47.6
No idea	23.2
Strong medical recommendation	18.9
Not brought up at all	7.6
Neutral pros & cons discussion	2.7

TABLE A12 — COMMUNITY EXPECTATION FOR NEWBORN BOYS

N = 142 / 213 / 109 / 37

culture_community_expectation

"In your family or the community you grew up in, what was the general EXPECTATION for newborn boys regarding circumcision?"

RESPONSE	INTACT %	CIRC. %	REST. %	OBS. %
Uncommon	33.8	22.9	16.5	11.8
Unquestioned norm	23.5	47.3	54.1	44.1
Very common	22.8	14.4	16.5	32.4
About 50/50	12.5	6.0	2.8	5.9
Not sure	7.4	9.5	10.1	5.9

TABLE A13 — FATHER'S CIRCUMCISION STATUS

N = 213 / 109

family_father_status

"What is your FATHER'S (or primary male guardian's) circumcision state, to the best of your knowledge?"

RESPONSE	CIRCUMCISED %	RESTORING %
Circumcised	67.1	75.2
Intact	24.2	15.6
Don't know	7.7	7.3
N/A	1.0	1.8

TABLE A14 — CONSIDERED RESTORATION OR REGENERATION?

CIRCUMCISED · N = 213

`circ_restoration_awareness`

"Have you ever considered or researched options like foreskin RESTORATION or REGENERATION?"

RESPONSE	%
Actively researching	27.5
Seriously considered	24.0
Briefly considered	23.0
Never considered	15.7
No	7.8
Unsure / never heard of it	2.0

TABLE A15 — PERSONAL AESTHETIC PREFERENCE

N = 142 / 213 / 109 / 37

`final_aesthetic_preference`

"Purely in terms of AESTHETICS (visual appearance), which look do you personally find more appealing?"

RESPONSE	INTACT %	CIRC. %	REST. %	OBS. %
Strongly prefer intact	65.2	52.0	90.7	48.5
Slightly prefer intact	14.5	10.8	2.8	12.1
No preference	8.0	9.3	3.7	18.2
Slightly prefer circumcised	6.5	7.8	1.9	15.2
Strongly prefer circumcised	5.8	20.1	0.9	6.1

TABLE A16 — ATTRIBUTE ASSOCIATIONS — ALL PATHWAYS COMBINED

BELIEFS MODULE · N = 474–478 PER ROW

`culture_assoc_medically_healthier` · `_more_hygienic` · `_more_natural` · `_more_sensitive` · `_more_masculine` · `_more_modern` · `_more_socially_acceptable`

"Please indicate which state (Intact or Circumcised) you believe is MORE LIKELY to be associated with the following attributes."

ATTRIBUTE	INTACT %	NEUTRAL %	CIRC. %	N
Greater pleasure potential	71.9	19.1	9.0	477
More "natural" looking	67.8	11.1	21.1	478
More modern / progressive	56.3	25.9	17.7	474
More "manly"	32.4	34.7	32.8	475
Medically healthier	31.2	22.2	46.5	477
More socially acceptable	27.6	21.9	50.4	474
More hygienic / cleaner	15.2	24.4	60.4	475

Percentages computed from the module's published response counts (rolling snapshot, N = 507 total).

TABLE A17 — BELIEF: WHICH STATE IS MEDICALLY HEALTHIER? N = 142 / 213 / 109 / 37

`final_healthier_hygienic_belief`

"Putting aside your personal satisfaction or feelings, which state do you generally believe to be MEDICALLY HEALTHIER or more HYGIENIC overall?"

RESPONSE	INTACT %	CIRC. %	REST. %	OBS. %
Intact, significantly	32.8	31.0	48.1	48.5
Intact, slightly	34.3	23.6	28.7	15.2
No difference	19.7	16.3	13.9	24.2
Circumcised, slightly	7.3	13.3	5.6	6.1
Circumcised, significantly	2.9	12.3	2.8	3.0
Unsure	2.9	3.4	0.9	3.0

APPENDIX B — QUESTION INDEX

INSTRUMENT WORDING

The exact instrument wording behind every measure cited in this report, with the pathways each question was asked of and where its results appear. Capitalization is the survey's own emphasis, reproduced verbatim. The full 355-question Master Index, with per-question deep-dives, is browsable at findings.circumsurvey.online.

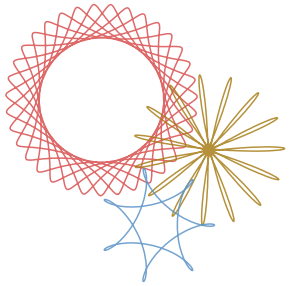
QUESTION, AS ASKED	ASKED OF	APPEARS IN
Thinking about your penis today, how do you generally FEEL about its physical appearance?	INTACT · CIRCUMCISED · RESTORING	FIG 17 · Table A1
Overall, how PROUD or satisfied are you with your penis?	INTACT · CIRCUMCISED · RESTORING	FIG 16 · Table A2
Please rate: the INTENSITY of your orgasms · the DURATION of your orgasms · your OVERALL EASE of reaching orgasm · your SENSITIVITY to light touch · your PLEASURE from mobile skin · the VARIETY of pleasurable sensations you experience. (Sexual Experience grid Q27.1–.6, each rated 1–5)	INTACT · CIRCUMCISED · RESTORING	FIG 09 · Table A3
…how would you rate your general confidence that your orgasms are as intense or fulfilling as possible?	INTACT · CIRCUMCISED · RESTORING	FIG 10 · Table A4
Do you generally need to use artificial LUBRICATION during sexual activity?	INTACT · CIRCUMCISED · RESTORING	FIG 11 · Table A5
DURATION: How long do the primary pleasurable sensations of your typical orgasm last?	INTACT · CIRCUMCISED · RESTORING	FIG 12 · Table A6
Have you experienced resentment, loss, anger, or grief about your circumcision?	CIRCUMCISED · RESTORING	FIG 13–14 · Table A7
Have you ever wished you were circumcised, or felt regret about being intact?	INTACT	FIG 13 · Table A7
Have you wondered what sex would be like with an intact penis?	CIRCUMCISED	FIG 15 · Table A8
Have you wondered what sex would be like if you were circumcised?	INTACT	FIG 15 · Table A8
Based on everything you know and have experienced, if you were to have a child assigned male at birth today, what would your decision regarding circumcision be?	ALL PATHWAYS	FIG 22 · Table A9
When considering a NON-THERAPEUTIC, irreversible surgical procedure on a healthy infant, which principle do you believe should be given more weight?	ALL PATHWAYS	FIG 23 · Table A10
Based on what you know, how was the topic of circumcision likely handled around the time of your birth?	CIRCUMCISED	FIG 18 · Table A11
In your family or the community you grew up in, what was the general EXPECTATION for newborn boys regarding circumcision?	ALL PATHWAYS	FIG 19 · Table A12
What is your FATHER'S (or primary male guardian's) circumcision state, to the best of your knowledge?	CIRCUMCISED · RESTORING	FIG 20 · Table A13
Have you ever considered or researched options like foreskin RESTORATION or REGENERATION?	CIRCUMCISED	FIG 21 · Table A14
When you began your restoration journey, what was your approximate starting Real Coverage Index (RCI) score, if you know or can estimate? / What is your approximate CURRENT Real Coverage Index (RCI) score, if you are still restoring?	RESTORING	FIG 24
Purely in terms of AESTHETICS (visual appearance), which look do you personally find more appealing?	ALL PATHWAYS	FIG 26 · Table A15

QUESTION, AS ASKED	ASKED OF	APPEARS IN
Please indicate which state (Intact or Circumcised) you believe is MORE LIKELY to be associated with the following attributes. [Medically Healthier · More Hygienic/Cleaner · More "Natural" Looking · More Sensitive/Greater Pleasure Potential · More "Manly" · More Modern/Progressive · More Socially Acceptable]	ALL PATHWAYS (BELIEFS MODULE)	FIG 25 · Table A16
Putting aside your personal satisfaction or feelings, which state do you generally believe to be MEDICALLY HEALTHIER or more HYGIENIC overall?	ALL PATHWAYS	FIG 27 · Table A17
Demographics battery: current age, generation, country of birth, family political lean, religiosity and tradition, education (own and parents'), childhood socioeconomic status, parents' occupations, sexual orientation, race/ethnicity. Observer respondents additionally state their role.	CROSS-TABBED FOR INTACT · CIRCUMCISED · RESTORING	FIG 01–08

★ SPECIAL REPORT ★

THE ACCIDENTAL INTACTIVIST'S INQUIRY

PHASE 1 FINDINGS REPORT · PRINT COMPANION



PHASE 1 FINDINGS REPORT · VERSION 1.0 · AUGUST 2026
CORE DATA FROZEN 2026-04-21 (N=501) · DEMOGRAPHICS 2026-04-18 (N=459) · BELIEFS MODULE ROLLING (N=507)
COMPILED FROM THE PROJECT'S PUBLISHED AGGREGATE FILES; FIG 24 STAGE CROSS-TABS COMPUTED FROM RAW RESPONSES — ONLY AGGREGATES PUBLISHED
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